

SCOPE OF WORK

XL Nexus HR Employee Service Portal

PARTIES TO THIS AGREEMENT	
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Project Details

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1 INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background

XL Nexus currently operates a fragmented, largely manual HR environment. Employee data is dispersed across multiple sources, disciplinary records are inconsistently maintained, leave management lacks real-time validation, and performance processes are not uniformly enforced. These deficiencies create compliance risk, operational inefficiency, and a poor employee experience.

1.2 Purpose of this Document

This Scope of Work (SOW) defines the agreed boundaries of delivery for the XL Nexus HR Employee Service Portal. It establishes the business context, the functional capabilities to be delivered, applicable constraints, and the basis for acceptance. This document serves as the contractual and technical baseline for the design, development, and implementation engagement between Poree Consulting Group and XL Nexus.

1.3 Strategic Objective

To establish a fully digitised, governed HR operating model that centralises employee data, enforces policy compliance, enables structured performance management, and empowers employees through self-service — reducing administrative overhead and mitigating compliance and regulatory risk.

2 SCOPE OF WORK

2.1 In Scope

The following modules and capabilities are included within this engagement:

#	Deliverable
1	Employee profile management module.
2	Disciplinary Record Repository (embedded in employee profiles).
3	Leave Management Module with policy enforcement and approval workflows.
4	Performance Management Module (balanced scorecard framework).
5	Payslip Access Module (via payroll system integration).
6	HR Policy Repository with version control.
7	Business announcements engine.
8	Administration & configuration module.
9	Workflow Engine (leave, performance, disciplinary).
10	Role-based access control (rbac) framework.
11	Reporting & analytics dashboard.
12	Payroll System API Integration (payslip retrieval).
13	Data Warehouse API Integration (KPI ingestion — Phase 2).
14	Audit Logging across all modules.

2.2 Out of Scope

The following items are explicitly excluded from this engagement:

#	Exclusion	Notes
1	Payroll calculation and tax processing.	Remains within the existing payroll platform.
2	Recruitment and onboarding workflows.	Managed by a separate specialist system.
3	External learning management / training systems.	Integration may be considered in a future phase.
4	KPI calculation and performance scoring logic.	Data ingested from the data warehouse; calculation is external to this system.

2.3 Assumptions

This engagement is based on the following assumptions. Any material deviation will be subject to change control:

- A payroll system exists and can securely expose payslip data via API.
- HR policies have been formalised and are available in digital format for upload to the portal.
- A KPI framework exists or will be defined prior to the Phase 2 data warehouse integration.
- A clearly structured organisational hierarchy (grades, reporting lines, departments) is available and will be provided for system configuration prior to build commencement.
- A data warehouse is available or will be made available for KPI ingestion in Phase 2.

2.4 Dependencies

Successful delivery is contingent on the timely provision of the following by XL Nexus:

- Payroll system API availability, credentials, and technical documentation.
- Data warehouse readiness and a structured KPI data schema for Phase 2.
- Formalised HR policy documents provided in digital format.
- Organisational structure data (grades, departments, reporting lines) provided prior to system build.

2.5 Constraints

- The system must comply with all applicable South African labour legislation.
- The system must comply with the Protection of Personal Information Act (POPIA).
- Disciplinary records must be immutable once finalised; retrospective alteration is not permitted.
- All personal and sensitive employee data must be encrypted at rest and in transit using industry-standard protocols.

3 STAKEHOLDERS & USER ROLES

The following roles will interact with the system, each with defined access levels and responsibilities:

Role	Access Level	Primary Responsibilities
Employee	Self-service	View own profile, submit leave requests, access payslips, view HR policies and announcements, complete performance inputs.
Line Manager	Team-level operational	Approve leave requests, conduct performance reviews, manage disciplinary records for direct reports.
HR Manager	Organisation-wide	Oversee all modules, manage HR policies, monitor compliance, configure workflows and entitlements.
Executive Management	Read-only aggregate	Access aggregated reports, performance dashboards, and workforce analytics.
System Administrator	System-level	Manage roles, permissions, system configurations, and organisational structure data.

4 BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS

Business requirements define what the organisation needs the system to achieve. Each requirement is linked to one or more functional requirements detailed in Section 5.

4.1 BR-01 — Centralised Employee Data

Priority: **Critical**

The organisation requires a single, authoritative source of truth for all employee data, eliminating fragmented records across departments and systems.

Acceptance Criteria

- All employees have a complete, structured digital profile.
- All mandatory fields are enforced at system level.
- All changes are logged with timestamps and user identifiers.

4.2 BR-02 — Governed Leave Management

Priority: **Critical**

Leave management must be policy-driven and automated, eliminating manual processing and ensuring compliance with grading-based entitlements.

Acceptance Criteria

- Leave requests are validated against real-time balances and entitlements.
- Insufficient balances trigger alerts and require override approval.
- A complete transactional history is maintained for every employee.

4.3 BR-03 — Consistent Performance Management

Priority: **Critical**

Performance reviews must be consistently executed across all defined cycles (monthly, quarterly, biannual, annual) and must be completed before incentive processing.

Acceptance Criteria

- The system prompts and enforces review cycles for all employees.
- All performance submissions follow a defined approval workflow.
- Performance data is stored and retrievable for audit and reporting purposes.

4.4 BR-04 — Auditable Disciplinary Records

Priority: **Critical**

All disciplinary actions must be formally recorded within the system and protected from retrospective alteration.

Acceptance Criteria

- Disciplinary records including warnings and supporting documents are captured and stored against the employee profile.
- Records are immutable once finalised.
- Access is restricted to authorised roles only.

4.5 BR-05 — Employee Self-Service Access

Priority: **High**

Employees must be able to independently access their payslips and HR policies without reliance on HR intervention, reducing administrative overhead.

Acceptance Criteria

- Employees can view and download payslips on demand.
- Employees can access and download all applicable HR policies.
- Self-service actions are available without HR mediation.

4.6 BR-06 — Internal Communication

Priority: **Medium**

The organisation requires a structured mechanism for distributing business announcements to targeted employee groups.

Acceptance Criteria

- Announcements can be created, targeted, and distributed by authorised administrators.
- Employees receive in-system notifications for relevant announcements.

4.7 BR-07 — Compliance & Data Governance

Priority: **Critical**

The system must enforce data privacy, security, and regulatory compliance aligned with POPIA and applicable South African labour law.

Acceptance Criteria

- All sensitive data is encrypted at rest and in transit.
- Role-based access controls prevent unauthorised data access.
- All system actions are logged and auditable.

4.8 BR-08 — Management Reporting & Visibility

Priority: **High**

Management requires real-time visibility of workforce data across leave, performance, and disciplinary dimensions to support strategic decision-making.

Acceptance Criteria

- Reports are available in real time with filtering and drill-down capability.
- Executive dashboards provide aggregated workforce metrics.

5 FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

Functional requirements define how the system must behave to satisfy the business requirements above. Each requirement is assigned a unique identifier, priority, and mapped to its parent business requirement.

5.1 Employee Profile Management

FR ID	Requirement	Priority	Linked BR
FR-EPM-01	The system shall capture and store structured employee profiles including personal information, employment details, organisational hierarchy, grade, and reporting line.	Critical	BR-01
FR-EPM-02	The system shall enforce mandatory field completion and prevent profile submission when required fields are absent.	Critical	BR-01
FR-EPM-03	The system shall log all profile changes with a timestamp, the user who made the change, and the previous value.	Critical	BR-01, BR-07
FR-EPM-04	The system shall support updating employee records and maintain a full version history of all changes.	High	BR-01
FR-EPM-05	The system shall restrict profile access to the individual employee, their line manager, and HR, based on assigned role.	Critical	BR-07

5.2 Disciplinary Record Repository

FR ID	Requirement	Priority	Linked BR
FR-DIS-01	The system shall provide a disciplinary record repository embedded within each employee profile.	Critical	BR-04
FR-DIS-02	Authorised users shall be able to capture disciplinary actions including the type of offence, sanction issued, date, and supporting documentation.	Critical	BR-04
FR-DIS-03	Once a disciplinary record is marked as finalised, it shall be immutable and no further edits shall be permitted.	Critical	BR-04, BR-07
FR-DIS-04	The system shall restrict creation, viewing, and management of disciplinary records to Line Managers, HR Managers, and System Administrators.	Critical	BR-04, BR-07
FR-DIS-05	The system shall maintain a complete audit trail of all disciplinary record actions including creation and status changes.	Critical	BR-04, BR-07

5.3 Leave Management

FR ID	Requirement	Priority	Linked BR
FR-LVE-01	The system shall allow employees to submit leave requests through a structured online interface, specifying leave type, dates, and reason.	Critical	BR-02
FR-LVE-02	The system shall validate each leave request against the employee's current leave balance and grading-based entitlement in real time.	Critical	BR-02
FR-LVE-03	Where a leave balance is insufficient, the system shall display an alert notification and require an authorised override for the request to proceed.	Critical	BR-02
FR-LVE-04	Leave requests shall follow a defined approval workflow: Employee → Line Manager → HR (where applicable).	Critical	BR-02
FR-LVE-05	The system shall update leave balances in real time upon approval of a leave request.	Critical	BR-02
FR-LVE-06	The system shall maintain a complete, immutable history of all leave transactions per employee.	High	BR-02, BR-07
FR-LVE-07	The system shall notify employees of approval, rejection, or escalation of their leave requests via in-system notification.	High	BR-02
FR-LVE-08	Line Managers shall have visibility of team leave calendars to assess operational impact before approving requests.	High	BR-02, BR-08

5.4 Performance Management

FR ID	Requirement	Priority	Linked BR
FR-PFM-01	The system shall support a balanced scorecard performance framework with evaluation cycles including monthly check-ins, quarterly KPI reviews, biannual, and annual evaluations.	Critical	BR-03
FR-PFM-02	The system shall prompt employees and line managers to complete performance inputs at the start of each defined review cycle.	Critical	BR-03
FR-PFM-03	KPI data shall be captured manually by the line manager or employee within the system during Phase 1.	Critical	BR-03
FR-PFM-04	The system shall be architected to support future automated KPI ingestion from a data warehouse via API (Phase 2).	High	BR-03
FR-PFM-05	All performance submissions shall follow an approval workflow: Employee input → Line Manager review → HR sign-off.	Critical	BR-03
FR-PFM-06	The system shall prevent incentive processing from proceeding unless all required performance reviews for the relevant cycle are completed and approved.	Critical	BR-03
FR-PFM-07	All performance records shall be stored and accessible for historical review, reporting, and audit.	High	BR-03, BR-07

5.5 Payslip Access

FR ID	Requirement	Priority	Linked BR
FR-PAY-01	The system shall retrieve payslip data from the payroll system via a secure API integration.	Critical	BR-05
FR-PAY-02	Employees shall be able to view and download their payslips on demand within the portal.	Critical	BR-05
FR-PAY-03	Payslip access shall be strictly restricted to the individual employee; no other role shall have access to another employee's payslip.	Critical	BR-05, BR-07
FR-PAY-04	The system shall display a historical list of available payslips, filterable by date period.	High	BR-05

5.6 HR Policy Repository

FR ID	Requirement	Priority	Linked BR
FR-POL-01	The system shall provide a centralised repository for HR policies, accessible to all employees.	High	BR-05
FR-POL-02	Administrators shall be able to upload, update, and archive policy documents with version control.	High	BR-05, BR-07
FR-POL-03	Employees shall be able to view and download policies applicable to them.	High	BR-05
FR-POL-04	The system shall retain previous versions of policy documents for audit purposes.	Medium	BR-07

5.7 Business Announcements

FR ID	Requirement	Priority	Linked BR
FR-ANN-01	Authorised administrators shall be able to create, schedule, and publish business announcements within the portal.	Medium	BR-06
FR-ANN-02	Announcements shall support targeting by department, grade, or employee group.	Medium	BR-06
FR-ANN-03	The system shall trigger in-system notifications to relevant employees upon announcement publication.	Medium	BR-06

5.8 Administration Module

FR ID	Requirement	Priority	Linked BR
FR-ADM-01	The system shall provide a dedicated administration interface for managing user roles, permissions, and system configurations.	Critical	BR-07
FR-ADM-02	Administrators shall be able to manage organisational structure including departments, grades, and reporting lines.	Critical	BR-01
FR-ADM-03	Administrators shall be able to configure leave types, entitlements per grade, and workflow approval rules.	Critical	BR-02
FR-ADM-04	Administrators shall be able to manage policy documents and announcement content.	High	BR-05, BR-06

5.9 Reporting & Analytics

FR ID	Requirement	Priority	Linked BR
FR-RPT-01	The system shall provide real-time reports on leave utilisation by employee, department, and leave type.	High	BR-08
FR-RPT-02	The system shall provide performance scorecards showing completion rates and scores across all review cycles.	High	BR-08
FR-RPT-03	The system shall provide disciplinary trend reports showing frequency, type, and recurrence of incidents.	High	BR-08
FR-RPT-04	All reports shall support filtering by date range, department, grade, and employee.	High	BR-08
FR-RPT-05	Executive dashboards shall provide aggregated, anonymised workforce metrics suitable for strategic review.	High	BR-08

5.10 Security & Access Control

FR ID	Requirement	Priority	Linked BR
FR-SEC-01	The system shall implement role-based access control (RBAC) ensuring users access only data authorised for their role.	Critical	BR-07
FR-SEC-02	All data at rest and in transit shall be encrypted using industry-standard protocols.	Critical	BR-07
FR-SEC-03	All user actions within the system shall be logged with a timestamp, user identity, and action detail.	Critical	BR-07
FR-SEC-04	The system shall support session management including automatic timeout after a defined period of inactivity.	High	BR-07

5.11 Integration Requirements

FR ID	Requirement	Priority	Linked BR
FR-INT-01	The system shall integrate with the payroll system via a secure API to retrieve employee payslips.	Critical	BR-05
FR-INT-02	The integration shall support both real-time and scheduled data retrieval.	High	BR-05
FR-INT-03	The system shall be designed to support future integration with a data warehouse for automated KPI ingestion (Phase 2).	High	BR-03
FR-INT-04	Integration failures shall be handled gracefully with appropriate error messages and retry logic and flagged to system administrators.	High	BR-07

6 NON-FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

NFR ID	Category	Requirement
NFR-01	Performance	System response time shall not exceed 10 seconds for standard user interactions under normal load.
NFR-02	Availability	The system shall target 99.5% uptime during business hours.
NFR-03	Scalability	The system shall be designed to scale to accommodate organisational growth without architectural rework.
NFR-04	Usability	The interface shall be intuitive, role-specific, and responsive across desktop and mobile browsers.
NFR-05	Compliance	The system shall comply with POPIA and applicable South African labour legislation.
NFR-06	Auditability	All transactional data shall be fully auditable with a complete history of actions.

7 ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

The system will be formally accepted as complete and ready for go-live when all of the following criteria are met and verified through User Acceptance Testing (UAT):

1. All employee records are fully digitised and accessible within the portal.
2. All leave requests are submitted, validated, and approved exclusively within the system.
3. Performance reviews are completed for all employees across all defined cycles.
4. Disciplinary records are fully captured, immutable, and auditable.
5. Employees can independently access payslips and HR policies without HR assistance.
6. All integrations (payroll API) are functional, tested, and validated.
7. Role-based access controls are verified and enforced across all modules.
8. User Acceptance Testing (UAT) is signed off by HR, Line Management, and Executive stakeholders.

8 CHANGE CONTROL

Any requirements not explicitly listed in Section 2.1 (In Scope) or detailed in Sections 4 and 5 of this document, are considered out of scope for this engagement.

Any addition or modification to requirements after sign-off of this document must follow Poree Consulting Group's formal change control process, which includes:

- Submission of a Change Request (CR) detailing the proposed change.
- Impact assessment on project timeline, cost, and resources.
- Written approval from authorised representatives of both XL Nexus and Poree Consulting Group prior to implementation.

Poree Consulting Group reserves the right to reassess delivery commitments and pricing in the event of approved scope changes.

9 AGREEMENT & SIGNATURES

The duly authorised representatives of the Parties hereby agree to the terms and conditions set out in this document:

For and on behalf of PCG / MindRift	For and on behalf of [Client]
Authorised Signatory:	Authorised Signatory:
Name:	Name:
Designation:	Designation:
Date:	Date: